

EMERGENCY ACTION PLAN — DO THIS TODAY

For: John Doe

Your deadline is shown on your summons. Do not wait.

IMMEDIATELY — Next 24 Hours

- ☐ Find your eviction summons. Look for the DEADLINE DATE and CASE NUMBER.
- ☐ Write the deadline on your calendar. Set a phone alarm 2 days BEFORE it.
- ☐ Read this entire packet. You will need to understand every document.
- ☐ If you can, call a friend or family member. You do not have to do this alone.

NEXT — Within 1-2 Days

- ☐ Fill out and SIGN your Answer form (separate PDF). Use blue or black ink.
- ☐ Complete your fee waiver form if you cannot afford the filing fee.
- ☐ Make 3 copies of EVERYTHING. The court clerk keeps the original.

FILE — Before Your Deadline

- ☐ Go to the courthouse in person OR e-file online if available in your court (see Filing Checklist in this packet).
- ☐ Bring: signed Answer form, fee waiver form, copies of everything, photo ID.
- ☐ Ask the clerk to stamp your copies as FILED. Keep one for yourself.
- ☐ If filing by mail, use certified mail with return receipt.

AFTER FILING — Serve the Landlord

- ☐ Deliver a filed copy to your landlord or their attorney.
- ☐ Do this by certified mail, hand delivery, or email (with read receipt).
- ☐ Keep PROOF — mail receipt, delivery confirmation, or email screenshot.

PREPARE FOR COURT

- ☐ Read the Defenses Explained document to understand your legal options.
- ☐ Read the Evidence Guide and start gathering evidence TODAY.
- ☐ Review the Hearing Script. Practice saying it out loud.
- ☐ Call the rental assistance numbers in this packet. Apply for help immediately.

IF YOU MISS YOUR DEADLINE: The judge may enter a default judgment against you and you could be evicted without a hearing. **THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT THING.** File your answer on time.

IMPORTANT: This document is provided for informational purposes only. It is not legal advice. If you need legal advice, contact a licensed attorney. You are responsible for your own case and what you say in court.